

		Plaintiff SHALL file and serve a status report <u>no later than 10 court days before</u> the hearing. Plaintiffs to give notice.
9	Pena vs. American Honda Motor Co., Inc.	<u>Motion for Attorneys' Fees</u> The court GRANTS in part Plaintiff CASPAR A. PENA's motion for attorney's fees. As a preliminary matter, there is no dispute that the motion is timely brought or that Plaintiff is entitled to fees. The parties dispute the amount of fees sought. Plaintiff seeks fees in the total amount of \$29,748.75. Defendant opposes the motion, requesting the court exercise its discretion to disallow fees altogether or alternatively, to greatly reduce counsel's requested attorney's fees to "at most" \$4,165.00. "In evaluating whether the attorney fee request is reasonable, the trial court should consider "' whether the case was overstaffed, how much time the attorneys spent on particular claims, and whether the hours were reasonably expended.'" (<i>Morris v. Hyundai Motor America</i> (2019) 41 Cal.App.5th 24, 38.) "'Reasonable compensation does not include compensation for "'padding" in the form of inefficient or duplicative efforts....' [Citations.] "A reduced award might be fully justified by a general observation that an attorney overlitigated a case or submitted a padded bill or that the opposing party has stated valid objections.'" (<i>Ibid.</i>) "[V]erified time statements of the attorneys, as officers of the court, are entitled to credence in the absence of a clear indication the records are erroneous." (<i>Horsford v. Board of Trustees of California State University</i> (2005) 132 Cal.App.4th 359, 396.) In support of the hourly rates claimed by each attorney who worked on this matter, Plaintiff's counsel includes what seems to be a running tally of cases up to and including June 2026, where Plaintiff's counsel received